Install the course software

UvA researchers' AI course 2026. Do this at home, before the first evening. It takes 7 to 20 minutes, depending on your internet connection and your machine.

Before you start

You need an internet connection, your normal user account, and a Claude account. The course email tells you which subscription to buy. The setup scripts are in the zip attached to this email. Keep its files together, because the script needs the other files next to it.

The script installs Git, Python 3.12, VS Code and Claude Code, then creates a **research-course** folder in your home folder with a Python environment and one folder per lab. Running it twice is safe. Anything already installed is skipped.

Windows 10 or 11

1. Save the attached zip, right-click it and choose Extract All. The script will not run from inside the zip.
2. Open the extracted folder and double-click `setup-windows.bat`. If Windows shows a blue "Windows protected your PC" box, click More info, then Run anyway. If it shows a security warning with a Run button, click Run. Approve any other Windows prompts.
3. A black window shows the progress. Wait for the green text Setup finished, then press any key to close it.
4. Open PowerShell from the Start menu and check:

```
cd $HOME\research-course; .\.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1; cd lab0-intro; claude
```

macOS

1. Save the attached zip and double-click it to unpack it.
2. Open the unpacked folder and double-click `setup-mac.command`. Terminal opens and starts the setup. It does not ask for your password.
3. If macOS says it cannot check the file for malware, click Done. Open System Settings, go to Privacy & Security, scroll down, click Open Anyway next to `setup-mac.command` and confirm. On macOS 14 or older, right-click the file and choose Open instead.
4. If a window asks to install the Command Line Tools, click Install. Wait for the green text Setup finished, then press any key to close the window. Open a new Terminal and check:

```
cd ~/research-course && source .venv/bin/activate && cd lab0-intro && claude
```

The first time you type claude

Claude Code opens a browser window. Log in with your Claude account and go back to the terminal. If you see a prompt waiting for you, you are ready for the first evening.

If something goes wrong

Run the script again first, since it picks up where it stopped. If it still fails, take a screenshot of the last lines in red or yellow and email it to Gjorgji Strezoski at g.strezoski@uva.nl. A few machines always need help, especially UvA-managed laptops. We sort those out before the course, and on the night you can work in pairs.

If double-clicking does not work on Windows, type `powershell` in the address bar of the folder and run `powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\setup-windows.ps1`. On a Mac, type `cd` and a space in Terminal, drag the folder onto the window, press Enter and run `bash setup-mac.sh`.

On Windows, if Activate.ps1 is blocked, run `Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope CurrentUser RemoteSigned` once and try again. On a Mac, if claude or code is not found, close every Terminal window and open a new one.

To remove everything later, double-click `teardown-windows.bat` or `teardown-mac.command` in the same folder. It asks you to type YES, then deletes the research-course folder, so copy out your work first.